

The London Marathon: Iconic City Race [B2]

È uno degli eventi podistici più iconici al mondo. Unisce sport e beneficenza, sensibilizza il pubblico sulle diversità e mostra i luoghi simbolo di Londra.

The London Marathon is one of the most famous running events in the world. Every spring, [big crowds flock to](#) the streets of London to [cheer on](#) the runners. Millions more watch the marathon on television. For many people it is more than a race, it is a celebration of community, charity and personal [achievement](#).

OLYMPIC FOUNDATION

The first London marathon was held in 1981. It was founded by former Olympic athletes Chris Brasher and John Disley. Inspired by the New York City Marathon, they wanted to create an event that would [bring people together](#) and show London [at its best](#). It was open to elite athletes and everyday runners, which helped to give it a friendly and inclusive feel. Over the years, the 26.2-mile race has grown into one of the six most prestigious marathons in the world, [alongside](#) Boston, London, New York, Berlin, Chicago, and Tokyo. Last year's event had over 55,000 participants. Because demand is so high, most runners have to [enter a public ballot](#), which is often heavily oversubscribed. The 2026 ballot had over a million applicants!

CHARITY LINKS

One of the London Marathon's greatest cultural contributions is its [link](#) to charity. It is widely known as the world's biggest one-day [fundraising](#) event. Runners support thousands of different causes, from medical research to local community groups. Many participants run in memory of loved ones, others [aim to raise awareness](#) of issues that matter to them, and this charitable spirit is a big reason why the race is so loved by the public. Main Landmarks Along the London Marathon Course.

A CELEBRATION OF DIVERSITY

The race also includes wheelchair athletes and [visually-impaired](#) runners, highlighting its inclusive nature. [On a lighter note](#), many runners wear [fancy dress](#), with [costumes](#) ranging from superheroes to [household objects](#). Over the years, the marathon has seen dinosaurs, [slices of toast](#), and even [landmarks](#) taking part. Places

Llanwrtyd Wells: Home to the World's Weirdest Events Una gara di corsa tra uomini e cavalli? Fare snorkeling in una palude? Due idee che, per quanto strampalate, sono ormai una tradizione in questo villaggio del Galles, famoso per i suoi eventi assurdi. Justin Ratcliffe

SCENIC COURSE

The course itself is one of the most [scenic](#) in the world. It starts in south-east London, near Greenwich, close to the famous Cutty Sark. Runners then head along the River Thames, passing historic areas and modern city views. One memorable moment is crossing Tower Bridge around the halfway mark. Then, the route goes through the tall buildings of Canary Wharf, before turning back towards central London. The final [stretch](#) passes the Houses of Parliament and Big Ben, with the finish line on The Mall, near Buckingham Palace. This mix of history and modern life makes the London Marathon truly special.

Glossary

- **link** = legame
- **fundraising** = raccolta fondi
- **raise awareness** = sensibilizzare
- **cheer on** = fare il tifo
- **achievement** = risultato
- **alongside** = insieme a
- **aim to** = avere come obiettivo
- **household objects** = oggetti domestici
- **scenic** = pittoreschi
- **bring people together** = riunire
- **fancy dress** = travestimenti
- **costumes** = costumi
- **slices of toast** = fette di pane tostato
- **landmarks** = monumenti
- **stretch** = tratto
- **big crowds** = grandi folle
- **enter a public ballot** = partecipare a un sorteggio
- **visually-impaired** = con disabilità visiva
- **On a lighter note** = parlando di cose più leggere
- **flock to** = accorrere in massa
- **at its best** = al suo meglio